

This is not a template. This is a **Netflix Adaptation**.

"Paperback" is the language of *New York Times* Bestsellers—thrillers, modern romance, and airport page-turners. It relies on the **"Commercial Pulse"**: The design must disappear so the reader can consume the story at speed, but the chapter openings must hit like a title card in a movie.

To elevate "Paperback" to God-Tier, we must solve the hardest problem in typography: **Setting a novel in Sans-Serif without making it look like a manual**. We abandon the sterile Lato for a "Humanist" Sans that breathes like a Serif.

Here is the **Paperback Commercial System 2.0**.

### 1. The Design Philosophy: "The Cinematic Page-Turner"

Current sans-serif fiction templates feel cold.

#### The New Paperback Principle:

- **Humanist Rhythm:** We do not use geometric fonts (like Arial or Futura) for body text. They fatigue the eye. We use a **Humanist Sans** with calligraphic roots (stroke variation) to guide the eye along the line.
- **The "Title Card" Chapter:** Every chapter opening is a dramatic pause. We use massive, condensed typography to signal "New Scene."
- **Tighter is Faster:** We increase the "density" of the text block slightly (tighter leading) to encourage rapid reading, mimicking the urgency of a thriller.

### 2. The Typographic Stack (The "Bestseller" Choice)

*Lato is too round and friendly. We need narrative drive.*

- **Body Type: Alegreya Sans or Fira Sans.**
  - *Why:* These are "calligraphic" sans-serifs. If you look closely, the strokes have thicks and thins, mimicking a pen. This creates a horizontal flow that geometric fonts lack. It feels "warm" and "story-like."
  - *Settings:* Scale=1.0.
- **Headings/Display: Bebas Neue or Oswald.**
  - *Why:* Tall, condensed, all-caps. It screams "Movie Poster."
- **The "Scene Break": \*\*\* or a customized glyph (e.g., a dagger †).**

### 3. The Layout System: "The Pocket Grid"

We emulate the layout of a mass-market paperback (5.5" x 8.5").

| Zone | Function |
|------|----------|
|------|----------|

|                       |                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Gutter</b>     | Extra wide (0.875in). Paperbacks are glue-bound tightly; text shouldn't vanish into the spine.                                                      |
| <b>The Text Block</b> | Narrow margins on the outside (0.5in). This maximizes word count per page (crucial for printing costs) while maintaining a comfortable line length. |
| <b>The Header</b>     | <b>Running Heads:</b> <i>Part Title</i> (Left) / <i>Chapter Title</i> (Right). Centered, Small Caps, Sans-Serif.                                    |

#### 4. Implementation Command (The Code)

Give this prompt to Claude to generate the **Paperback 2.0** engine.

**ROLE: COMMERCIAL BOOK DESIGNER / XeLaTeX ENGINEER**

**PROJECT: PAPERBACK FICTION TEMPLATE (PRINT PREPRESS)**

#### OBJECTIVE:

Create the .latex template for "**Paperback.**" This is a modern, commercial fiction template designed for 5.5 x 8.5 inch trade paperbacks.

#### 1. THE GEOMETRY (geometry package)

- **Page Size:** 5.5in x 8.5in.
- **Margins:**
  - Inner: 0.875in (Gutter allowance).
  - Outer: 0.5in.
  - Top: 0.75in.
  - Bottom: 0.75in.
- **Paragraphs:**
  - `\setlength{\parindent}{1.5em}` (Standard fiction indent).
  - `\setlength{\parskip}{0pt}` (No space between paragraphs).

#### 2. THE TYPOGRAPHY (fontspec)

- **Main Font:** Alegreya Sans (Humanist Sans).
  - *Features:* Ligatures=TeX.
- **Display Font:** Bebas Neue (Condensed).
- **Alignment:** `\RaggedRight` (Modern feel) OR `\justify` (Classic feel) — *Set to RaggedRight per user request, but enable `\hyphenpenalty=100` to keep the rag tight.*

### 3. THE "CINEMATIC" COMPONENTS (titlesec)

- **Chapter Headings (\chapter):**
  - **Style:** Dramatic Drop.
  - **Vertical Space:** Drop 2 inches.
  - **The Number:** Huge (60pt), Bebas Neue, Color=Black!15 (Light Grey), Right Aligned.
  - **The Title:** Large (24pt), Alegreya Sans Bold, Right Aligned, overlapping the number slightly.
  - **The Text:** Starts immediately after with a **Phrase-Cap** (First 3 words in Small Caps).
- **Scene Breaks:**
  - A centered, bold \* \* \* or a custom glyph to indicate time passing.

### 4. THE HEADER/FOOTER (fancyhdr)

- **Clean:** Page number centered in the footer.
- **Header:** Author Name (Verso) / Book Title (Recto) in \sffamily\scshape\footnotesize.

**Generate the full paperback.latex file compatible with Pandoc.**

### Why this is "God-Tier" for Paperback

1. **Alegreya Sans:** It solves the "Uncanny Valley" of sans-serif fiction. It feels literary despite having no feet.
2. **The Grey Number:** By placing a massive, light-grey chapter number *behind* or near the text, you add visual texture to the page without distracting the reader. It looks like a high-budget design.
3. **The Gutter Fix:** Most amateur templates forget that trade paperbacks don't lay flat. A 0.875in inner margin ensures the reader never has to break the spine to read the words.